



International Conference on
Advancing Food Science and Nutrition by Bridging Research, Policy, and Practice
October 13-14, 2025



Conference Program



**International Conference on
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Inaugural Session

Monday, October 13, 2025

Presided by: Prof. Dr. Najeeb ur Rehman, Director, COMSATS University Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus

Chief Guest: Mr. Zubair Ahmed Ejaz, Director Operations, Punjab Food Authority, Government of Punjab

Venue: Auditorium, COMSATS University, Islamabad (CUI), Sahiwal Campus

TIME (hrs.)	ACTIVITY
08:30-10:00	Registration and Socialization
10:00-10:05	Recitation of Holy Quran
10:05-10:10	Naat-e-Rasool-e-Maqbool
10:10-10:15	National Anthem
10:15-10:20	Welcome Address by Dr. Muhammad Ibrahim, Head, Department of Biosciences, COMSATS University Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus
10:20-10:30	Conference theme by Prof. Dr. Muhammad Atif Randhawa, President, Pakistan Society of Food Scientist and Technologists, Pakistan
10:30-10:50	Keynote Address by Prof. Dr. Muhammad Issa Khan, Director General, National Institute of Food Science and Technology, University of Agriculture, Faisalabad
10:50-11:10	Keynote Address by Prof. Dr. Tahir Zahoor, Dean, Faculty of Applied Sciences at NUR International University, Lahore
11:10-11:30	Keynote Address by Prof. Dr. Xianju Huang, College of Pharmaceutical Science, South-Central Minzu University, Wuhan, China
11:30-11:50	Address by Chief Guest, Mr. Zubair Ahmed Ejaz, Director Operations, Punjab Food Authority, Government of Punjab, Pakistan
11:50-12:10	Vote of thanks by Prof. Dr. Najeeb ur Rahman, Director, COMSATS University Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus
12:10-12:30	Distribution of Souvenirs and Group Photo
12:30- 13:30	Lunch and Prayer Break



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Technical Session 1: Combating Malnutrition and Hidden Hunger through Nutrition Innovation

Venue: Auditorium, A Block COMSATS University, Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus

Time (hrs.): 13:30-16:00

Chair: Prof. Dr. Issa Khan

Co-Chair: Dr. Abrar Hussain

Moderator: Ms. Sunaina

TIME (hrs.)	TITLE OF PRESENTATION, SPEAKERS, AND AFFILIATION
13:30-13:45	Title: The Hidden Risks of Nutritional Supplements in Pakistan Authors: Muhammad Asghar Khan Affiliation: National University of Medical Sciences, Rawalpindi, Pakistan
13:45-14:00	Title: Impact of Microcredit with Inputs on Nutrition and Food Security and Women Empowerment: Evidence from Panel Data of Bangladesh Author: MD. Mizanur Rahman Sarker Affiliation: Department of Agricultural Statistics, Sher-e-Bangla Agricultural University (SAU) Dhaka Bangladesh,
14:00-14:15	Title: Investigating the effect of stabilized rice bran on nutritional profile and physical properties of wheat flour-based bread Author: Salman Munir Affiliation: National Institute of Food Science and Technology, University of Agriculture, Faisalabad,
14:15-14:30	Title: Front-of-Pack Labelling (FOPL) as a Public Health Priority for Pakistan: Bridging the Gap Between Nutrition Literacy and Non-Communicable Disease Prevention Author: Sanaullah Iqbal Affiliation: Department of Food Science and Human Nutrition, University of Veterinary and Animal Sciences, Lahore
14:30-14:45	Title: Pollinator declines impact the health and wealth of smallholder farmers Author: Mr. Sujan Sapkota Affiliation: Program Manager, HERD International, Bhaisepati, Nepal.
14:45-15:00	Title: Advancing Nutritional Fortification Through Best Practices in Chemical & Machinery Procurement Authors: Faheem Azher Affiliation: Sultan Group Pakistan, F.A Traders, Source Factory, Faisalabad, Pakistan
15:00-15:15	Title: Addressing Malnutrition Through Micro-Nutrient Powder in Children Author: Qirat Sitara Affiliation: Department of Human Nutrition and Dietetics, MNS-University of Agriculture, Multan, Pakistan
15:15-15:30	Title: Pumpkin Seeds and Flaxseeds Fortification in Whole Wheat Flour Author: Alina Sadaf Affiliation: Department of Food Science and Technology, MNS-University of Agriculture, Multan, Pakistan
15:30-15:40	Distribution of Souvenirs and Certificates to the Session Chairs and Authors
15:40-16:00	Tea



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Technical Session 2: Academia–Industry–Government Collaboration for Nutritional Security

Venue: Conference Room D Block, COMSATS University, Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus
Time (hrs.): 13:30-16:00
Chair: Prof. Dr. Tahir Zahoor
Co-Chair: Prof. Dr. Umar Farooq
Moderator: Ms. Aneeqa

TIME (hrs.)	TITLE OF PRESENTATION, SPEAKERS, AND AFFILIATION
13:30-13:45	Title: Food and Nutrition Entrepreneurship: Challenges and Opportunities in Pakistan Author: Mian Kamran Sharif Affiliation: National Institute of Food Science and Technology, University of Agriculture, Faisalabad, Pakistan
13:45-14:00	Title: From Policy to Plate: How Punjab's Food Regulations Are Shaping Safety and Consumer Awareness Author: Shinawar Waseem Ali Affiliation: Department of Food Sciences, University of the Punjab, Quaid-e-Azam Campus, Lahore, Pakistan
14:00-14:15	Title: Management of non-communicable diseases, the role of the Food Scientist Author: Humphrey Garti Affiliation: Department of Nutritional Sciences, School of Allied Health Sciences, University for Development Studies (UDS), Ghana
14:15-14:30	Title: Evaluation of the Total Antioxidant Capacity of Anchusa italica Retz using carbon fiber microelectrode modified by Au–Ag alloy urchin-like nanostructures Author: Han Cheng Affiliation: School of Pharmaceutical Sciences, South-Central Minzu University, Wuhan, China
14:30-14:45	Title: Fortifying Corn Extrudates with Chickpea: A Step Toward Combating Malnutrition Author: Sadaf Shakoor Affiliation: University of Agriculture, Faisalabad, Burewala Campus.
14:45-15:00	Title: Management of Hypomagnesemia in Patients through Pumpkin seeds Authors: Umar Farooq Affiliation: Faculty of Food and Home Sciences, MNS University of Agriculture Multan
15:00-15:15	Title: Development of white kidney bean-based beverage using Lactobacillus plantarum as starter culture Author: Mohammad Shoaib Affiliation: National Institute of Food Science and Technology, University of Agriculture, Faisalabad
15:15-15:30	Title: Malnutrition: A Major Killer of Children Author: Rizwan Tariq Affiliation: Department of Food Sciences, University of the Punjab, Quaid-e-Azam Campus, Lahore, Pakistan
15:30-15:40	Distribution of Souvenirs and Certificates to the Session Chairs and Authors
15:40-16:00	Tea



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Technical Session 3: Innovations in Food Science, Nutrition, and Sustainability

Venue: Conference Room B Block, COMSATS University, Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus
Time (hrs.): 13:30-16:00
Chair: Prof. Dr. Farhan Saeed
Co-Chair: Dr. Muhammad Nadeem
Moderator: Ms. Fatima Javaid

TIME (hrs.)	TITLE OF PRESENTATION, SPEAKERS, AND AFFILIATION
13:30-13:45	Title: The Role of Nanotechnology in Improving Nutrient Delivery in Fortified Foods Muhammad Asif Khan Department of Food Science and Technology, The Islamia University of Bahawalpur, Pakistan
13:45-14:00	Title: Exploring the Potential of Molasses-Based Golden Syrup as a Sweetener in Lemon Barley Squash Author: Muhammad Farhan Jahangir Chughtai Affiliation: Institute of Food Science and Technology, Khawaja Fareed University of Engineering and Information Technology, Rahim Yar Khan, Pakistan
14:00-14:15	Title: Probing The Bioactive Profile of Fermented Garlic in Relation to Its Hypoglycemic Potential Author: Farhan Saeed
14:15-14:30	Title: Green Proteins, Stronger Pakistan: A Sustainable Strategy for Health and Economic Development Author: Muhammad Sameem Javed Affiliation: Department of Food Safety and Quality Management, Faculty of Food Science
14:30-14:45	Title: Enhancing Food Security in Pakistan: Addressing Climate Challenges, Industry-Academia Collaboration, and Malnutrition Syndromes Author: Tahseen Fatima Miano Affiliation: Institute of Food Sciences and Technology, Sindh Agriculture University, Tandojam, Sindh, Pakistan
14:45-15:00	Title: Ethnoveterinary Practices and Impact of Medicinal Flora on Milk Quality and Animal Health in the Central Karakoram National Park (CKNP) Region of Baltistan Author: Farrukh Faiz Affiliation: Department of Agriculture and Food Technology/Director Advanced Studies and Research, Karakoram International University, Gilgit, Pakistan
15:00-15:15	Title: A Comprehensive Review of the Molecular Mechanism of Lycopene in Cancer Therapy Author: Muhammad Imran Affiliation: Department of Food Science & Technology, University of Narowal-Pakistan
15:15-15:30	Title: Advancing Food Safety and Nutrition through Innovation, Awareness, and Shared Responsibility Author: Rai Muhammad Amir Affiliation: Institute of Food and Nutritional Sciences, PMAS-Arid Agriculture University,
15:30-15:40	Distribution of Souvenirs and Certificates to the session chairs and authors
15:40-16:00	Tea



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Tuesday, October 14, 2025

Technical Session 4: Advances in Functional Foods, Probiotics, and Nutraceuticals

Venue: Auditorium, A Block COMSATS University, Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus

Time (hrs.): 9:00-11:00

Chair: Dr. Manan Aslam

Co-Chair: Dr. Awais Ihsan

Moderator: Ms. Mehwish

TIME (hrs.)	TITLE OF PRESENTATION, SPEAKERS, AND AFFILIATION
9:00-9:15	Title: Ensuring Food Security in a Changing Climate: Challenges, Innovations, and Sustainable Pathways Author: Abdul Mannan, Affiliation: Project Director, Kasalin Foods Pvt. Ltd
9:15-9:30	Title: Effects of drying temperature and solvent on the contents of major polyphenols and pharmacological activity in lemongrass (<i>Cymbopogon citratus</i> (DC.) Stapf) leaf extracts Author: Muhammad Zubair Affiliation: Department of Bioinformatics and Biotechnology, Government College University (GCU), Faisalabad, Pakistan
9:30-9:45	Title: Exploring immuno-modulatory mechanisms of Poly herbal formulations against COVID-19 using an integrated network pharmacology approach Author: Ijaz Rasool Affiliation: Department of Bioinformatics and Biotechnology, Government College University Faisalabad, Allama Iqbal Road, Faisalabad, Pakistan
9:45-10:00	Title: Determinants of ICTs Adoption for Minimizing Agricultural Losses among Smallholder Farmers in Punjab, Pakistan: Implications for Food Security and Sustainable Rural Development. Author: Manan Aslam Affiliation: School of Management, Jiangsu University, Zhenjiang, Jiangsu, P.R. China Multan, Pakistan
10:00-10:15	Title: Synthesis of Iron and Potassium Oxide Nanoparticles from <i>Allium porrum</i> Leaves, A Sustainable Approach to Enhanced Soil Fertility and Growth of Potato (<i>Solanum tuberosum</i>) and Fenugreek (<i>Trigonella foenum-graecum</i>) Author: Ummara Waheed Affiliation: Institute of Plant Breeding and Biotechnology MNS-University of Agriculture, Multan
10:15-10:30	Title: Efficacy and Safety Assessment of Iron and Zinc Fortified Rice on Physiological Health Markers in Controlled Albino Rat Model Author: Ayesha Hakim Affiliation: Department of Biosciences, COMSATS University Islamabad Sahiwal Campus
10:30-10:45	Title: Entomophagy: Addressing Malnutrition Through Nutritional Fortification in Pregnant Women Author: Mamoon Ahmad Affiliation: Department of Human Nutrition and Dietetics, MNS-University of Agriculture,
10:45-11:00	Distribution of Souvenirs and Certificates to the session chairs and authors
11:00-12:00	Closing Ceremony
12:00-16:00	Lunch and visit to Harappa



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Technical Session 5: Sustainable Food Systems and Agricultural Innovation

Venue: Conference Room D Block, COMSATS University, Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus
Time (hrs.): 9:00-11:00
Chair: Dr. Muhammad Ibrahim
Co-Chair: Dr. Muhammad Wasim Sajid
Moderator: Ms. Zahra Batool

TIME (hrs.)	TITLE OF PRESENTATION, SPEAKERS, AND AFFILIATION
9:00-9:15	Title: Enhancing Land Productivity and Farm Income through Cotton–Soybean Intercropping Author: Akaash Fatima Affiliation: Institute of Plant Breeding and Biotechnology, MNS University of Agriculture, Multan.
9:15-9:30	Title: Impact of Leaf Rust Disease on Wheat Grain Yield and Nutritional composition Author: Sania Javeed Affiliation: Institute of Plant Protection, MNS-University of Agriculture, Multan, Pakistan
9:30-9:45	Title: Development of a Calcium Rich Cookie with Incorporation of Eggshell Powder: A Sustainable Approach to Nutrient Fortification Author: Rimsha Nasir Affiliation: Department of Food Science and Technology, Jinnah University for Women, Karachi
9:45-10:00	Title: Machine Learning Based Assessment of Water Quality Using Physico-Chemical Parameters for Sustainable Agriculture Author: Junaid Iqbal Affiliation: Institute of Computing MNS - University of Agriculture, Multan.
10:00-10:15	Title: Virulence and Antimicrobial Resistance Potential of Foodborne <i>Staphylococcus</i> Species: Emphasis on Food Safety Author: Rafia Zaheer Affiliation: Department of Microbiology, Quaid I Azam University, Islamabad, Pakistan
10:15-10:30	Title: Role of single nucleotide polymorphisms (SNPs) in TaGSNE a WRKY transcription factor associated with agronomic and grain related traits under drought and heat stress in Pakistani wheat varieties Author: Muhammad Sabir Affiliation: Department of Genetics, University of Karachi, Pakistan
10:30-10:45	Title: Traditional and Indigenous Food Systems: Pathways to Address the Global Syndemic Author: Muneeba Javed Affiliation: National Institute of Food Science and Technology, University of Agriculture Faisalabad, Pakistan
10:45-11:00	Distribution of Souvenirs and Certificates to the session chairs and authors
11:00-12:00	Closing Ceremony
12:00-16:00	Lunch and visit to Harappa